

Contribution of Founding Fathers: Allama Iqbal & Quaid-i-Azam

VISIONARIES BEHIND THE IDEOLOGY AND REALITY OF PAKISTAN

Why Revisit the Founding Fathers?

- Nations are shaped by visionary leadership, not just events
  - Shaped political, social, and intellectual path
- Modern-day Pakistan owes them, their ideas & struggles
- Iqbal & Jinnah began as territorial nationalists
- Evolved through experience and ground realities
- Their transformation gave direction to Muslim identity and Pakistan

Allama Iqbal: The Ideological Architect

Poet-philosopher, spiritual father of Pakistan

Envisioned a separate Muslim identity

Critic of both Western materialism & Indian nationalism



جہانِ تازہ کی افکارِ تازہ سے ہے نمود
کہ سنگ و خشت سے ہوتے نہیں جہاں پیدا

From Indian Nationalist to Muslim Ideologue

- Early supporter of composite nationalism
- سارے جہاں سے اچھا ہندوستاں ہمارا
  - reflects early hopes for unity
- Shifted stance after observing Muslim marginalization
- Advocated for a distinct Muslim identity & destiny

Iqbal – The Ideological & Intellectual Catalyst

The Concept of "Khudi" (The Self):

- In *Asrar-i-Khudi*, Iqbal argues that the "Self" is not a spirit to be suppressed (as in some mystic traditions) but a force to be strengthened.
- **Political Application:** If the individual is strong, the nation (*Millat*) becomes invincible.

The “Mu'min" (The True Believer):

- Iqbal sought a leadership that combined spiritual depth with modern scientific inquiry.

Critique of Western Democracy & Nationalism:

- He warned that simple "head-counting" in a multi-religious India would lead to the "tyranny of the majority”
- Religious ties beyond borders

Iqbal’s vision for a Separate Muslim State

- Muslims as a separate nation — not a minority
- Islam as a complete system of life, not just faith
- **The 1930 Allahabad Address**
- **Context:** The Third Round Table Conference era
- **Beyond Geography:** Iqbal didn't just want a "piece of land"; he wanted a space where the "ethical ideal" of Islam could be practiced
- **Addressing the World:** He argued that a stable Muslim state in NW India would be the best guarantee of peace for the entire Middle East and Asia. Separation as a necessity, not rebellion

Philosophical Foundations of Iqbal's Vision

- *Khudi* – Strength of selfhood and self-respect
- *Ijtihad* – Reinterpretation of Islamic thought
- *Spiritual Democracy* – Ethical governance
- Sought an awakened, independent Muslim ummah

From Thought to Political Influence

Inspired Muslim leaders, Especially Jinnah:

- correspondence (1936–38)

Urged Jinnah to lead Muslims politically

Saw Jinnah as the only leader who could safeguard Muslim future

From poetic vision to political mobilization

M. A Jinnah: From Ambassador of Hindu-Muslim Unity to Muslim Leader

Believed in Indian unity till 1920s

Advocated Hindu-Muslim unity through law & constitution

Disillusioned by Congress behavior

Gradually turned from Indian nationalism to Muslim nationhood



Gist of Jinnah's 14 Points (1929) – The Constitutional Shield

The Catalyst: The Nehru Report (1928) which suggested ending separate electorates

Key Provisions Added:

- **State Services:** Muslims should have an adequate share in all services of the State.
- **Cultural Protection:** No bill should be passed if 3/4ths of the community members oppose it
- **Religious Liberty:** Full religious liberty for all communities

Legacy: These points proved Jinnah was a "Constitutionalist" who only turned to separatism when all avenues of partnership were closed

The Correspondence (1936–1937)

The "Conversion" of Jinnah: In a series of private letters, Iqbal convinced Jinnah that the "Bread Question" (economic survival) for Muslims could only be solved in an independent state.

Iqbal’s Endorsement: *"You are the only Muslim in India today to whom the community has a right to look up for safe guidance through the storm."*

Jinnah’s Realization: Jinnah moved from being a "Minority Leader" to a "National Leader."

Jinnah's Leadership: Turning Vision into Reality

Reorganized AIML as the voice of Muslims

Lahore Resolution 1940:

- Clear demand for Pakistan

Strategic leadership during

- Cabinet Mission,
- Cripps, and Partition

Created a state without war:

- Through diplomacy and persistence



Jinnah’s Leadership Style – "The Sole Spokesman"

Strategic Ambiguity: (Insight from Ayesha Jalal) Jinnah used the demand for Pakistan as a "bargaining counter" initially to get the best possible terms for Muslims, which eventually evolved into an absolute demand.

Mass Mobilization: After 1937, he adopted the title "Quaid-e-Azam" and began wearing the *Sherwani* and *Karakul* hat to resonate with the common man.

Legal Precision: His arguments were so logically sound that British negotiators like Lord Mountbatten found him "an ice-cold logician."

The 1945-46 Elections – The Final Mandate

The Campaign: The Muslim League fought on a single-point agenda: **"Pakistan"**

The Verdict:

- **Central Assembly:** 30/30 Muslim seats won
- **Provincial Assemblies:** 425/496 Muslim seats won

Significance: This democratic victory silenced the British and Congress claim that the League did not represent the masses

The Transfer of Power (1947)

The Cabinet Mission Plan (1946): Jinnah initially accepted a federated India, but Congress's refusal to honor the "grouping clause" led Jinnah to call for **"Direct Action Day."**

Mountbatten Plan (June 3rd): The formal partition plan

August 14, 1947: Jinnah's vision (fueled by Iqbal's philosophy) became a physical reality

Comparative Legacy

Concept	Iqbal’s Contribution	Jinnah’s Contribution
Nationalism	Based on "Faith" (Religious Identity)	Based on "Self-Determination" (Political Rights)
Approach	Intuitive and Revolutionary	Evolutionary and Constitutional
Final Goal	A "Spiritual Democracy"	A modern "Islamic Republic"

The Two-Nation Theory and Muslim Identity

- Muslims as a separate nation by
  - culture, religion, and values
- Congress's insistence on majoritarian rule exposed fault lines
- Jinnah redefined Muslim politics on the basis of identity & rights
- Political survival required ideological clarity

Founding Fathers

- The creation of the largest Muslim state at the time (1947)
- For which Iqbal provided the **Ideological Boundary**; Jinnah struggled to provide the **Geographic Boundary**.
- "Iqbal is no more amongst us, but had he been alive he would have been happy to know that we did exactly what he wanted us to do" (Reportedly after the presidential speech during the meeting of Lahore, March, 1940 https://www.iqbal.com.pk/iis-allama-iqbal-learning-centre/public-educational-campaigns/944-allama-iqbal-studies/scholarly-articles/1626-statements-of-quaid-i-azam-about-allama-iqbal.html)

Traits of Real Leadership: Lessons from Iqbal & Jinnah

- Leadership means growth, not rigidity
- Ability to adapt ideas to historical realities
- Prioritized community above personal gain
- Leader’s courage shapes national destiny